

# The Noble Perfection of Wisdom in Few Syllables

Āryasvalpākṣaraprajñāpāramitā nāma mahāyānasūtra · Toh 530 · Derge Kangyur

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Toh 530 in the Kangyur is a Mahāyāna sūtra known in Sanskrit as the Āryasvalpākṣaraprajñāpāramitā and in Tibetan as the Noble Perfection of Wisdom in Few Syllables. As its name suggests, it belongs to the Prajñāpāramitā, or Perfection of Wisdom, family of texts — scriptures concerned with the nature of emptiness and transcendent wisdom — and takes the compact form of a dhāraṇī, a condensed sacred formula embodying that wisdom. The text is set at Vulture Peak Mountain near Rājagṛha, where the Buddha addresses a vast assembly of monks, bodhisattvas, and gods, a classic framing shared with many sūtras of this genre. It was translated from Sanskrit into Tibetan by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla together with the renowned Tibetan editor-translator Yeshé Dé, and was subsequently revised in accordance with the standardized later translation conventions.

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The noble great dhāraṇī is complete.

This was translated by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla, together with the great editor-translator the monk Yeshé Dé, and was also revised and finalized according to the new language conventions.

In the Indian language: Āryasvalpākṣaraprajñāpāramitā nāma mahāyānasūtra.  
In the Tibetan language: The Noble Perfection of Wisdom in Few Syllables — a Mahāyāna sūtra.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling on Vulture Peak Mountain at Rājagṛha, together with a great Saṅgha of twelve thousand five hundred monks, and with many tens of millions of hundreds of thousands of bodhisattvas, surrounded by many tens of millions of hundreds of thousands of gods — Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods), Brahmā, the World-Protectors, and others — who gazed upon him from before. He was seated upon a lion throne adorned with a glorious jewel-heart.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee upon the ground, and with his palms joined in reverence turned toward the Blessed One, and bowing with a smile, he addressed the Blessed One in these words:

"Blessed One, please speak of the great merit in this Perfection of Wisdom in Few Syllables — that through the mere hearing of it all the karmic obscurations of all sentient beings will be purified, that they will be led to certain inclination toward awakening, and that those who strive in mantra-practice will accomplish the mantras without obstruction."

Then the Blessed One said "Excellent!" to the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, and spoke: "Well done, well done, son of good family! It is excellent that for a long time you have striven for the benefit of all sentient beings. Therefore, son of good family, listen well and take it to heart — I shall now explain to you this Perfection of Wisdom in Few Syllables, of great merit, through the mere hearing of which all the karmic obscurations of all sentient beings will be purified, they will be led to certain inclination toward awakening, and those who strive in secret mantra-practice will accomplish the mantras without obstruction."

Then the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara said to the Blessed One: "Please speak it for the healing of all sentient beings."

Then at that moment the Blessed One entered into the meditative absorption called "Liberation of All Sentient Beings." From within that meditative equipoise, many hundreds of thousands of rays of light streamed forth from the tuft of hair between his brows, and those rays of light pervaded all buddha-fields everywhere. All sentient beings touched by those rays of light — down to the beings in the hells — were all of them definitively established in the unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. All buddha-fields, too, trembled in six ways. And a rain of celestial sandalwood powder fell near the feet of the Tathāgata.

Then at that time the Blessed One taught this Perfection of Wisdom, as follows:

The bodhisattva should cultivate a mind of equanimity, a mind of loving-kindness, a mind that nurtures what has been done, and a mind free from all wrongdoing. This heart-essence of the Perfection of Wisdom should also be recited:

Homage to the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly complete buddha, Śākyamuni.

Tadyathā: oṃ mune mune mahāmunaye svāhā.

"By obtaining this Perfection of Wisdom, I attained the unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. All buddhas, too, arose from it. And because you have

received this very teaching from the great Tathāgata Śākyamuni, you have thereby become supreme among all bodhisattvas, great beings." He also gave a prophecy of buddhahood, saying: "You shall become a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly complete buddha, known as King Glorious Heap of Rays of Light (Skt. Raśmisaṃcayaprabhārāja)."

"All those who hear your name, who hold it, who recite it, who teach it extensively to others, and who write it in a book and make offerings to it — all of them, in a future time, shall become Tathāgatas."

Tadyathā: jaya jaya, padmabhe, ava me sara saraṇi, dhiri dhiri, dhiri dhiri, devatānupālāne, buddha uttaraṇi pūraya bhagavati, sarvā śama śama sarvasattvānāṃ, sarva karmāvaraṇa viśodhaya, buddha adhiṣṭhānena svāhā.

In its ultimate sense, this Perfection of Wisdom is that which gives birth to all buddhas, which is the mother of bodhisattvas, which instantly strips away evil, and which bestows awakening. Indeed, were all the buddhas to speak of its benefits for a hundred million eons, they would not be able to exhaust them. By reciting this teaching, one receives empowerment into all maṇḍalas, and all secret mantras will become manifest.

Then the noble bodhisattva, the great being Avalokiteśvara said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, for what reason is this called the Perfection of Wisdom?"

The Blessed One declared: "Because it is an easy method. Whatever sentient beings have little enthusiasm — those who hold, recite, transcribe, or commission the transcription of this Perfection of Wisdom — all of them, through this easy method, will incline toward awakening. Therefore it is called the Perfection of Wisdom."

When the Blessed One had spoken those words, the noble bodhisattva, the great being Avalokiteśvara again addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, how wondrous it is that, for the sake of healing all sentient beings, and for the sake and healing and happiness of beings of little merit, you have proclaimed this presentation of the Dharma. How wondrous is the Blessed One! How wondrous is the Sugata!"

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the noble bodhisattva, the great being Avalokiteśvara, those monks, those bodhisattvas, and the world together with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had taught.

This concludes the Mahāyāna sūtra called The Noble Perfection of Wisdom in Few Syllables.

## Translator's Notes

- The phrase "nurtures what has been done" renders the Tibetan "byāns pa gzo ba," which literally means "to preserve or tend what has been done." This is a somewhat uncommon ethical instruction in this context; it refers to cherishing or maintaining the good one has accumulated. The doctrinal point is not in doubt, but the phrasing is slightly elliptical.

The colophon at the opening identifies this as the conclusion of a prior text, specifically a "noble great dhāraṇī," before introducing the new sūtra title. The two are discrete texts in the canon; the first colophon closes the preceding work.

- The buddha name rendered as "King Glorious Heap of Rays of Light" translates the Tibetan རྒྱལ་བོ་གསལ་རྣམས་ཀྱི་རྡོ་རྒྱུད་ཀྱི་རྒྱལ་པོ་། literally. The Sanskrit reconstruction Raśmisamcayaprabhārāja is offered as an approximation; the exact canonical Sanskrit name may vary across recensions. The dhāraṇī syllables are rendered in standardized Roman transliteration as they appear in the Tibetan phonetic transcription, without normalization to classical Sanskrit, since this is a liturgical mantra passage where the phonetic form carries authority.

## Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.